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On Air · Sunny

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이번 호 기사

01	환경	Planting Trees on Empty Islands	2
02	기술	Will There Be Enough Power for Electric Cars?	3
03	사회	Who Really Owns Your Personal Data?	4
04	과학	Are Genome-Edited Crops Safe to Eat?	5
05	교육	Are Early School Times Hurting Teen Sleep?	6
06	건강	How Scientists Create Life-Saving Vaccines	7
07	환경	Why Cities Feel Hotter Than the Countryside	8
08	경제	Secondhand Shopping Changes How People Buy	9

Planting Trees on Empty Islands

By Sunny · 2026-07-30 · 138 words · L1



무인도에 나무를 심는 사람들

Some volunteers are planting trees on uninhabited islands, which are places where no people live. Their goal is to bring forests back to life.

Many islands lost their trees over time because people cut them down for wood or farming. Without trees, the soil becomes weak and animals lose their homes.

Planting trees can help in many important ways. Trees clean the air and hold the soil firmly in place. They also give birds and insects a safe and healthy place to live. Some groups have already planted millions of trees on small islands around the world.

This work takes a very long time, but the results can be truly amazing. Healthy forests can slowly grow back, and nature can recover. Many people believe that restoring island forests is one of the best ways to protect our planet.

한글 요약

자원봉사자들이 무인도에 나무를 심어 숲을 되살리는 활동을 펼치고 있다. 나무는 공기를 정화하고 토양을 보호하며 동물들에게 서식지를 제공하는 중요한 역할을 한다. 많은 사람들은 섬의 숲을 복원하는 것이 지구를 지키는 최선의 방법 중 하나라고 믿는다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

uninhabited 사람이 살지 않는
volunteer 자원봉사자
soil 토양, 흙
restore 복원하다, 되살리다

recover 회복하다
forest 숲
protect 보호하다

Will There Be Enough Power for Electric Cars?

By Sunny · 2026-07-30 · 226 words · L3



전기차가 늘면 전기는 충분할까

More and more people are buying electric vehicles, or EVs. They run on electricity instead of petrol, so they need to be plugged in and charged. But as the number of EVs grows, a big question is appearing: will the power grid have enough electricity for everyone?

A Growing Demand

The power grid is the system that sends electricity to homes, schools, and businesses. Each EV uses roughly as much electricity as a small house. If millions of people charge their cars at the same time, the grid can get overloaded.

Experts say this problem gets worse during peak hours, which are the times when people use the most electricity. Many drivers plug in their cars

right after work, which is exactly when homes are already using a lot of power.

Smart Solutions

One idea is to encourage drivers to charge their cars at night, when fewer people are using electricity. Some countries are trying special chargers that automatically choose the cheapest and quietest time to charge.

Renewable energy, like solar and wind power, is also part of the answer. If more clean energy is added to the grid, there will be more electricity available for everyone, including EV drivers.

Scientists believe that with smart planning, the grid can handle the extra demand. The key is to start preparing now, before EVs become even more common.

한글 요약

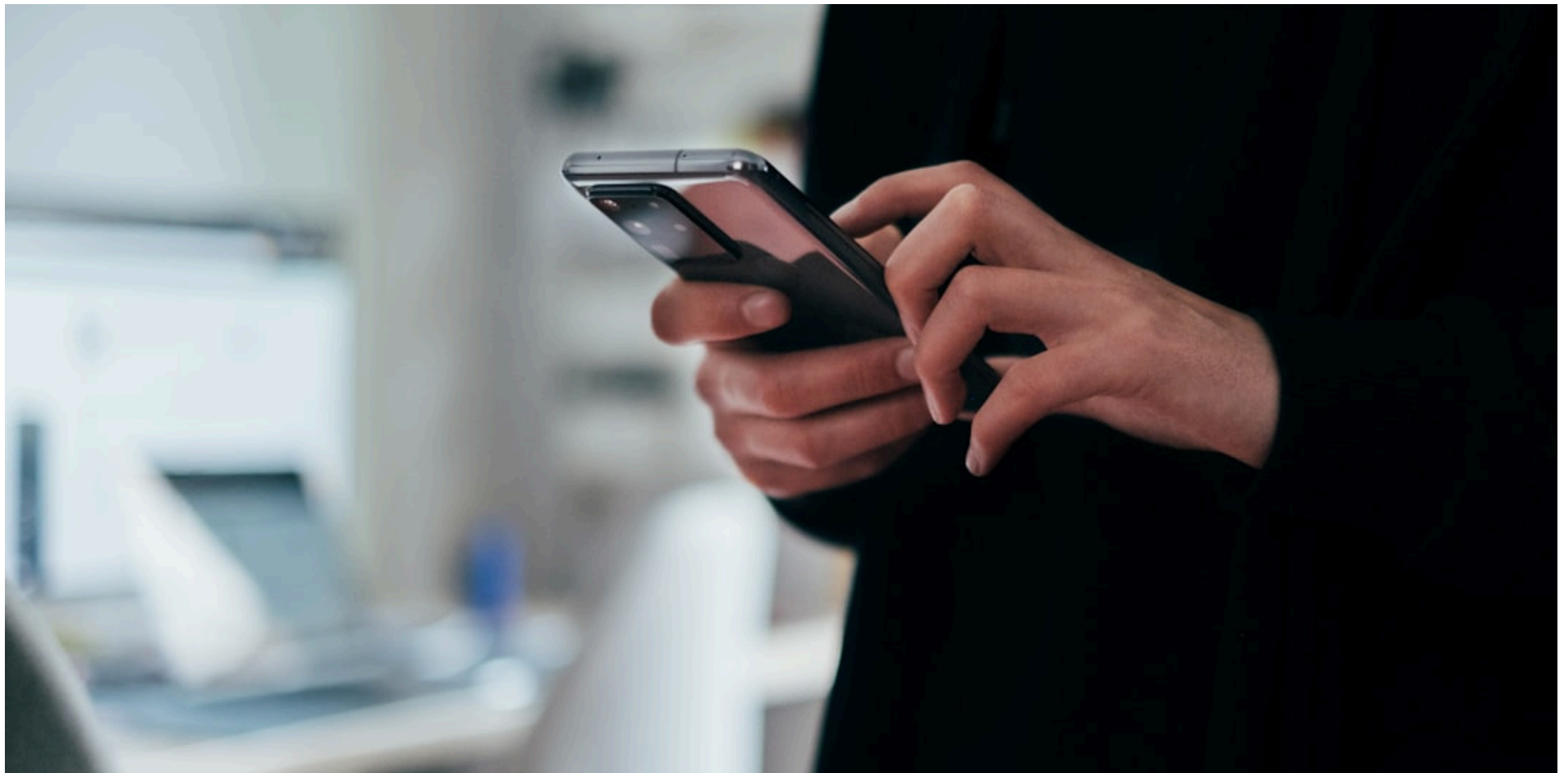
전기차 보급이 늘어나면서 전력망에 과부하가 걸릴 수 있다는 우려가 커지고 있다. 특히 퇴근 후 많은 사람이 동시에 충전하는 피크 타임이 문제로 지적된다. 전문가들은 심야 충전 유도, 재생에너지 확대 등 스마트한 대비책을 지금부터 마련해야 한다고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

electric vehicle	전기차	peak	최고, 절정의
grid	전력망, 송전망	renewable	재생 가능한
charge	충전하다	demand	수요, 필요량
overloaded	과부하가 걸린		

Who Really Owns Your Personal Data?

By Sunny · 2026-07-30 · 212 words · L3



개인정보는 누구의 것인가

Every time you use an app or sign up for a website, you share personal information. Your name, age, and even your location can be collected and stored by companies. But who does that information actually belong to?

Your Data, Your Rights

Many countries now have laws that say people should control their own personal information. In Europe, a law called GDPR lets people ask companies to show, fix, or delete their data. The United States also has rules that protect people from having their information shared without permission.

A Growing Global Question

Other parts of the world are also thinking about how to handle personal data. Some governments are working on new privacy laws of their own. It is a topic that experts and leaders around the world are taking more seriously each year.

One interesting point is that companies often use your data to show you ads or improve their services. Many people do not realize this is happening. Reading the terms and conditions of an app, though most people skip them, can help you understand what you agree to.

So who owns your personal data? Most experts agree that it should belong to you. But making sure that happens in real life still takes careful rules and informed users.

한글 요약

앱이나 웹사이트를 이용할 때마다 기업들은 우리의 이름, 나이, 위치 등 개인정보를 수집하고 저장한다. 유럽의 GDPR처럼 많은 나라에서 개인정보 보호법을 만들어 사람들이 자신의 데이터를 직접 통제할 수 있도록 하고 있다. 전문가들은 개인 데이터의 주인은 당연히 본인이어야 한다고 말하지만, 이를 현실에서 지키려면 강력한 규정과 이용자들의 인식이 모두 필요하다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

personal 개인적인, 자신의
collect 수집하다
permission 허락, 허가
privacy 사생활, 개인정보 보호

delete 삭제하다
terms 조건, 약관
informed 잘 아는, 정보를 갖춘

Are Genome-Edited Crops Safe to Eat?

By Sunny · 2026-07-30 · 219 words · L3



유전자 편집 작물, 안전할까

Scientists can now change the genes inside food crops. This is called genome editing, and it lets researchers add or remove tiny parts of a plant's DNA to make it grow better.

What Is Genome Editing?

DNA is like an instruction book inside every living thing. Scientists use special tools to find a specific part of a plant's instructions and change it. For example, they can make a tomato with more healthy nutrients, or a wheat plant that resists disease.

Are These Foods Safe?

Large scientific groups, including the US National Academy of Sciences, have studied this question carefully. They found that genome-edited foods do not seem to cause extra health risks compared to

regular food. However, many people are still not sure, and some feel that these crops need more long-term study.

Some people are also worried about the environment. For instance, if edited crops spread to wild plants, it could affect nature in ways that are hard to predict.

Governments around the world are making new rules about how genome-edited foods should be checked and labeled. Some people want clear labels on these products so shoppers can choose for themselves.

Scientists say this technology could help farmers grow more food as the climate changes. But the conversation about safety, labeling, and the environment is still going on.

한글 요약

게놈 편집은 식물의 DNA를 바꿔 더 건강하거나 병에 강한 작물을 만드는 기술이다. 미국 국립과학원 등 과학 단체들은 게놈 편집 식품이 일반 식품보다 특별히 더 위험하지 않다고 밝혔지만, 장기적인 연구와 환경 영향에 대한 우려도 여전히 존재한다. 각국 정부는 관련 규정을 만들고 있으며, 안전성과 라벨 표시를 둘러싼 사회적 논의는 계속되고 있다.

Source · ncbi.nlm.nih.gov, nationalgeographic.com

WORDS & MEANINGS

gene	유전자	predict	예측하다
DNA	DNA (유전정보를 담은 물질)	label	라벨을 붙이다; 표시하다
nutrient	영양소	technology	기술
resist	저항하다, 견디다		

Are Early School Times Hurting Teen Sleep?

By Sunny · 2026-07-30 · 167 words · L2



청소년 수면 부족과 등교 시간

Many teenagers around the world are not getting enough sleep. Doctors say most teens need between eight and ten hours of sleep each night, but studies show that many get far less than that.

One big reason is biology. When teenagers grow, their body clocks shift naturally, so they feel awake later at night and find it hard to wake up early. This is not laziness — it is a real change that happens inside the body.

Because of this, many health experts believe that school should start later in the

morning. Research has shown that teens who start school later sleep longer and feel better during the day. Some schools in the United States have already moved their start times to 8:30 a.m. or later, and students there reported feeling more focused in class.

However, changing school hours is not simple. Parents' work schedules and school bus timetables also need to change. Still, more schools are now looking seriously at this idea because student health matters.

한글 요약

전 세계 많은 청소년들이 권장 수면 시간인 8~10시간을 채우지 못하고 있으며, 이는 성장 과정에서 생체시계가 변화하는 생물학적 원인 때문이다. 보건 전문가들은 등교 시간을 늦추면 청소년의 수면과 집중력이 향상된다는 연구 결과를 근거로 학교 시작 시간 변경을 권고하고 있다. 미국 일부 학교는 이미 등교 시간을 오전 8시 30분 이후로 바꿨지만, 부모 출근 일정과 스쿨버스 운행 등 현실적인 문제도 함께 해결해야 하는 과제가 남아 있다.

Source · [biorxiv.org](https://www.biorxiv.org), [ncbi.nlm.nih.gov](https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov), [snexplores.org](https://www.snexplores.org)

WORDS & MEANINGS

biology 생물학, 생체 원리

shift 바뀌다, 이동하다

naturally 자연스럽게

expert 전문가

research 연구, 조사

focused 집중하는

schedule 일정, 시간표

How Scientists Create Life-Saving Vaccines

By Sunny · 2026-07-30 · 173 words · L2



백신은 어떻게 만들어질까

Every year, vaccines protect millions of people from serious diseases. But how does a tiny shot in the arm actually stop a dangerous illness? The answer starts deep inside a laboratory.

To make a vaccine, scientists first need to find the right part of a germ to use. Some vaccines use a weakened or killed version of the germ itself. Others use just a small piece of it, such as a protein from its surface, so the body can learn to recognize it.

Once scientists choose the right material, they grow large amounts of it carefully in special containers. After that, they clean and purify it so it is safe for the human body. They also add other ingredients to help the vaccine work better and last longer.

Before any vaccine reaches people, it must pass strict safety tests that take several years. Doctors and scientists check that it works well and does not cause harm. Because of all these careful steps, vaccines are one of the most trusted tools in medicine today.

한글 요약

백신은 세균의 일부나 약화된 세균을 이용해 우리 몸이 질병을 인식하고 싸울 수 있도록 훈련시킨다. 과학자들은 백신 재료를 대량으로 배양한 뒤 정제하고, 효과를 높이는 성분을 추가한다. 백신이 사람들에게 사용되기까지는 수 년에 걸친 엄격한 안전성 검사를 반드시 통과해야 한다.

Source · [britannica.com](#), [beyond.britannica.com](#)

WORDS & MEANINGS

vaccine 백신

germ 세균, 병원균

protein 단백질

purify 정제하다, 깨끗하게 하다

ingredient 성분, 재료

recognize 인식하다, 알아보다

laboratory 실험실

Why Cities Feel Hotter Than the Countryside

By Sunny · 2026-07-30 · 174 words · L2



도시의 열섬 현상

Have you ever noticed that cities feel much hotter than nearby forests or farmland? This effect is called the 'urban heat island,' and scientists around the world are studying it closely.

Cities are full of roads, buildings, and parking lots made of concrete and asphalt. These dark, hard surfaces absorb a lot of heat from the sun during the day. At night, they slowly release that heat into the air, so temperatures stay high even after sunset.

In contrast, trees and soil absorb less heat. They also release water into the air, which helps cool things down. Because cities have

fewer trees and plants, they lose this natural cooling effect.

A study of 32 cities in China found that urban areas can be several degrees warmer than the surrounding countryside. This extra heat can make people tired, cause health problems, and increase the use of air conditioners.

However, cities are now planting more trees and painting rooftops white to reflect sunlight. These steps can help bring temperatures down and make city life more comfortable.

한글 요약

도시는 콘크리트와 아스팔트가 태양열을 흡수하고 밤에 방출하는 '도시 열섬' 현상으로 인해 농촌보다 기온이 훨씬 높다. 이 현상은 사람들의 건강을 해치고 에어컨 사용량을 늘리는 등 다양한 문제를 일으킨다. 이를 해결하기 위해 도시들은 나무를 심거나 옥상을 흰색으로 칠하는 등의 방법으로 온도를 낮추려는 노력을 기울이고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

urban 도시의

absorb 흡수하다

concrete 콘크리트

release 방출하다, 내보내다

temperature 온도, 기온

reflect 반사하다

surrounding 주변의

Secondhand Shopping Changes How People Buy

By Sunny · 2026-07-30 · 174 words · L2



중고 거래가 바꾼 소비 문화

More and more people are choosing to buy and sell used goods instead of always buying new ones. Apps and online platforms have made this much easier, and the secondhand market is now growing quickly around the world.

In the past, buying used items often meant going to a flea market or a garage sale. Today, apps let people list their old clothes, electronics, and furniture online in just a few minutes. Buyers can search nearby and pick up items from their local area.

This shift is changing the way people think about shopping. Many buyers say they can save a lot of money by choosing used goods. At the same time, selling old items gives people a way to earn extra cash from things they no longer need.

There is also an environmental side to this trend. When products are reused instead of thrown away, less waste ends up in landfills. Some researchers say that growing secondhand culture could help reduce the amount of new goods that need to be produced each year.

한글 요약

앱과 온라인 플랫폼의 발달로 중고 물품을 사고파는 것이 쉬워지면서, 전 세계적으로 중고 시장이 빠르게 성장하고 있다. 소비자들은 중고 거래를 통해 돈을 절약하거나 부수입을 올릴 수 있다. 또한 제품을 재사용하면 쓰레기와 새 물건의 생산량을 줄일 수 있어 환경에도 긍정적인 영향을 미친다.

Source · ncbi.nlm.nih.gov

WORDS & MEANINGS

goods 상품, 물건

platform 플랫폼 (온라인 서비스 공간)

electronics 전자 제품

shift 변화, 전환

trend 경향, 트렌드

landfill 매립지, 쓰레기 매립장

reuse 재사용하다

